

Bridgetown Research: Building AI Agents for Professional Services

Purpose

The speaker discusses the challenges and progress in building AI agents for professional services, particularly in consulting, private equity (PE), venture capital (VC), and investment domains, emphasizing structural barriers and a solution built by Bridgetown Research.

Key Takeaways

- Professional services agents lag behind coding agents due to unique structural barriers, especially the scarcity of expert data.
- Bridgetown Research's platform, Team Room, captures expert workflows and decisions in real time to train AI models effectively.
- A data flywheel is emerging where firms generate valuable expert trajectories through daily work, improving model quality without upfront investment in data.
- Significant productivity gains are being realized, including reduced team sizes and costs, faster delivery, and expansion into previously uneconomical use cases.

Challenges in Agent Development for Professional Services

The speaker highlights that while AI performance has improved dramatically in domains like coding, progress in professional services has been limited. Two primary barriers explain this gap:

- Scarcity of ML Talent

While machine learning talent remains scarce, the speaker notes that this constraint is easing from both supply (more ML scientists entering the field) and demand (outsourcing infrastructure and deployment).

- Lack of Expert Data

This is the **biggest** constraint. **67%** of the cost in building effective professional services agents goes toward acquiring expert data - not compute. This data includes:

- Hypotheses formed
- Sources preferred
- Evidence gathered
- Draft insights and deliverables
- Critique and revision cycles
- Final decision rationale

Unlike verifiable coding tasks, professional services outputs must be client-ready, decision-ready, and defensible. The most critical resource is the expert trajectory - the full path of judgment, choices, and revisions made by professionals during a project.

Since this data is often scattered across emails, call notes, and unstructured folders, it's difficult to capture retroactively. Therefore, Bridgetown Research's approach focuses on capturing it going forward through their platform.

Bridgetown Research's Solution: Team Room

Team Room is an end-to-end operating platform designed for strategy, consulting, and investment professionals. It enables and records the full workflow:

- **Framing** of the problem and hypotheses
- **Research planning** with goal and question guide generation
- **Primary research** via AI agents conducting interviews (AI calls)
 - Over **90%** of calls are AI-driven, reducing time from weeks to days
 - Transcripts and insights are stored and traceable
- **Secondary research** from curated sources
- **Analysis and storylining**
 - Automatically drafts narratives with assertions backed by evidence
 - All insights are traceable to sources, transcripts, or documents
- **Critique and revision** captured live within the platform

Team Room integrates primary, secondary, and analysis agents, allowing professionals to solve business problems end-to-end. It compiles firm-specific data to fine-tune private, single-tenant models.

Impact and Use Cases

The platform has been deployed in over **200 live projects**, generating **3,000+ transcripts**. Key use cases include:

- Thesis development
- Origination screening
- P&L preparation
- Pre- and post-LOI due diligence (especially for mid-market funds)
- Value creation and transformation planning
- AI maturity diagnostics
- Tech diligences (e.g., code quality, deployment speed)

Measurable Outcomes

- Team sizes reduced from "M+4" to "0.5M + 2" or even a single analyst
- Delivery time reduced from **3 weeks** to **1.5-2 weeks** (some in **1 week**)
- Costs reduced to **a third** of previous levels
- Enables smaller firms to compete with larger consultants by offering faster, cheaper services
- Opens new workflows like tech due diligence, previously not offered by consulting firms

The Data Flywheel

As teams use Team Room, they generate firm-specific expert trajectories. This data:

- Feeds into model fine-tuning
- Improves agent performance over time
- **Does not require upfront investment** - data is generated naturally through work

Improvements post-deployment show **20-30%** greater output usability, with initial model output accepted **40%** of the time, rising with continuous learning.

Talent and Organizational Implications

AI is reshaping talent needs:

- The traditional consulting "pyramid" model is shrinking
- Fewer analysts and associates are needed as AI handles routine tasks
- Teams are moving toward a "cylinder" shape - narrower base, same top-tier expert roles
- Human judgment remains critical, especially at the partner level, but support layers are leaner

Despite gains, professionals still need to develop expertise through experience - but the path is faster and less reliant on junior staff doing repetitive work.

Quality Assurance

Quality is managed through:

- Human evaluation using custom rubrics assessing completeness, relevance, factual accuracy, and logic
- All corrections, edits, and feedback captured on-platform to guide model learning
- Firms choose preferred outputs, reinforcing their internal standards in the model

Action Items / Next Steps

- Continue deploying Team Room to capture firm-specific expert trajectories
- Expand into new industries: currently focused on tech, healthcare, and industrials
- Scale pilot programs with boutique consulting and investment firms
- Demonstrate ROI through reduced costs, time, and expanded service offerings
- Educate clients on transitioning to leaner talent models without sacrificing quality

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